

Emer Rafter

Role: Software Development Engineer

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Personal Statement

I'm a Software Engineer with 5 years of experience across full-stack development, QA, fintech, trading, and startup environments. I currently work at Gateway21, building production features for a fintech platform supporting financial promotion approvals and AI-assisted compliance workflows. I use TypeScript, React, Next.js, Python, PostgreSQL, Sequelize, and AWS. Before moving into development, I worked in QA roles at GetGround, the London Stock Exchange Group, Investec, and Nephila, gaining strong experience in test strategy, automation, API testing, production support, and release quality.

Experience

Software Development Engineer | Gateway21, London | June, 2025 - Present

- Build and maintain full-stack features for supporting financial promotion approvals and AI-assisted compliance workflows, using TypeScript, React, Next.js, Python, PostgreSQL, Sequelize, and AWS.
- Currently building an admissions and disclosure platform for crypto clients using Typescript, NextJS, PostgreSQL, Drizzle and AWS.
- Built a serverless email ingestion workflow to automate how inbound client emails and attachments enter Gateway21's internal review process
 - Built a serverless inbound email processing service using AWS SES, Lambda, S3, and PostgreSQL to process client emails, extract metadata, handle attachments, create portal records, and trigger failure alerts.
 - Configured SES inbound receipt rules to capture emails, store raw content and attachments in S3, and trigger Lambda-based parsing.
 - Added spam checks, validation handling, and failure alerts to improve reliability and reduce manual monitoring.
- Built an internal prompt management tool to give non-technical compliance and operations users more control over prompts used in AI-assisted workflows.
 - Built a prompt management interface with prompt versioning, categories, approval states, edit history, role-based access, and production/draft workflows.
 - Added created-by and updated-by metadata to improve visibility over prompt changes.
 - Gave internal teams a structured way to review and manage prompt changes without engineering support.
- Developed a prompt evaluation pipeline to help teams test prompt performance before releasing changes into production.
 - Built support for human review workflows, pass/fail thresholds, and golden datasets created by non-technical users.
 - Allowed teams to test prompts against approved examples before release, reducing the risk of poor-quality or inconsistent AI outputs.
 - Helped create a safer release process for AI-assisted features by making prompt performance easier to review and compare.
- Built a client-facing Slack app to let clients submit FinProm materials directly into the Gateway21 portal from Slack.
 - Built the app using TypeScript, AWS Lambda, S3, and the Slack API to support client file uploads and automated backend processing.
 - Integrated client authentication, file upload handling, Lambda processing, S3 storage, and PostgreSQL record creation.
 - Added portal status updates, internal team notifications, and error handling for invalid uploads.

Senior Quality Assurance Engineer | GetGround, London | Jan, 2023 - Oct, 2024

- Developed and implemented QA strategies at the project level for the team, identifying and executing necessary QA activities such as automation, end-to-end, manual and exploratory testing
- Developed and maintained automated tests and integrated them into GitHub-based CI/CD workflows.

- Reviewed end-to-end test results on a daily basis, ensuring timely identification and resolution of issues from automated test failures
- Championed QA best practices across teams by advocating for strong test coverage, shared quality ownership, and early QA involvement in the development lifecycle
- Provided production support on a daily basis, acted as primary point of contact between the customer support and engineering teams, efficiently triaging, documenting, prioritising issues
- Analysed server logs, user sessions and the database to diagnose the root cause of bugs/defects
- Experienced working with third party integrations including Stripe, Modulr, CurrencyCloud, Onfido, and WealthKernel
- Conducted API testing using Postman and Swagger to validate response data
- Collaborated with Product, Design, and other business stakeholders to define acceptance criteria and ensure comprehensive coverage of user journeys during early-stage feature development.
- Managed junior colleagues by guiding test plan reviews, offering constructive feedback to enhance the quality and coverage of testing and overseeing the triaging, prioritisation and resolution of issues
- Led squad ceremonies, including daily stand-ups, release planning, refinement sessions
- Consistently demonstrated excellence by being the only individual in a company of 85 to achieve a maximum rating in the year-end review for 2023

Trading Technology Consultant | First Derivatives, London | Sep, 2019 - Jan 2023

During my time at First Derivatives I worked on several projects and held the following roles:

QA Analyst | London Stock Exchange Group, London | Aug, 2021 - Jan 2023

- Led the timely delivery of quality product releases based off stakeholders' specifications
- Created and executed test scenarios and created automated testing suites
- Collaborated development teams in order to identify the root-cause of bugs and defects based on troubleshooting and analysis of testing evidence
- Managed junior QAs through onboarding, training and knowledge-sharing sessions

Support Analyst | Nephila, London | Mar, 2021 - Aug 2021

- Supported users in the form of answering queries, resolving problems, assisting with bug fixes
- Identified areas of product improvement within the application based on analysis of frequently seen issues

QA Analyst | Investec Wealth & Investment, London | Mar, 2020 - Mar 2021

- Prepared and delivered thorough QA testing reports and presented findings to stakeholders
- Created user guides, release notes, and product documentation for business users on Confluence

Professional Development

Northcoders Software Development Bootcamp in JavaScript | Jan 2025 - May 2025

Completed a 13-week full-stack JavaScript bootcamp at Northcoders, building and deploying applications with React, Node.js, databases, test-driven development, Git, agile methods, and pair programming.

Projects

NC News: Built a full-stack content-sharing platform with article browsing, commenting, and reactions, using React, Node.js, Express, PostgreSQL, SuperTest, and GitHub Actions. ([Link \(BE\)](#), [Link \(FE\)](#))

Study BuddAI: Built a full-stack AI study app that uses Gemini AI to turn PDF notes into custom multiple-choice quizzes, applying prompt engineering to structure unstructured content into usable quiz formats. ([Link \(FE\)](#), [Link \(BE\)](#))

Education

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (CLF-C02) | Amazon Web Services | 2026

Northcoders Software Development Bootcamp in Javascript | Jan 2025 - Apr 2025

Professional Diploma, UX Design | UX Design Institute | 2021 - 2022

M.A.I Biomedical Engineering | Trinity College Dublin | 2018 - 2019

B.A.I Biomedical Engineering | Trinity College Dublin | 2014 - 2018

B.A Mathematics | Trinity College Dublin | 2014 - 2018